



2020 GEORGES DE LATOUR PRIVATE RESERVE CABERNET SAUVIGNON

Beaulieu Vineyard Reserve wines are handcrafted from the finest grapes of the vintage, focusing on our premier estates in Rutherford, Carneros, and other Napa Valley appellations. For more than 100 years, Beaulieu Vineyard has set the benchmark for rich, classic Napa Valley wines. Our legacy honors the marriage between state-of-the-art technology and gentle, traditional winemaking methods, a combination that enhances the expression of our remarkable vineyard terroir.

Our Georges de Latour Private Reserve Cabernet Sauvignon has been widely recognized as the benchmark Cabernet Sauvignon from Rutherford since its inaugural vintage in 1936. Our understanding of terroir comes from more than 100 years of creating rich, classic Napa Valley wines.

TASTING NOTES

This vintage is a powerhouse example of our flagship wine, with an intense and fragrant bouquet of ripe, dark berries, grape compote, black cherry, orange peel, and black plum, alongside savory, perfumed notes of wild violet, rose petal, fresh spearmint, bay laurel, and earth. Warm baking spice notes from the French oak barrel influence add vanilla, caramel, and allspice. Saturated dark fruit is present and voluminous throughout the palate, exhibiting mouthcoating structure with density and enveloping richness. Full-bodied and multilayered, secondary notes of bittersweet dark chocolate, umami, leather, tobacco leaf, and graphite add additional nuance and complexity. The signature “Rutherford Dust” tannins are pronounced, framing the wine and presenting a firm grip with chewy, cocoa-powder texture. The mouthwatering palate is lively and fresh with balanced acidity, demonstrating length and a lovely generosity. Incredibly pleasing upon release, yet certain to age for many years to come.

VINTAGE

The 2020 season had a warm, dry winter and the rain and cooler weather didn't arrive until the end of March. A mild spring provided a great early start and summer brought very cool mornings and very warm days. While the harvest was smaller-yielding and proved to be one of the most challenging in history, our talented and always optimistic winemakers created wines of very high quality with concentrated flavors and excellent acidity, especially for varieties like Cabernet Sauvignon, from this unprecedented vintage.

VINEYARDS

We hand selected grapes from the finest Cabernet Sauvignon vines from the western bench of the Rutherford AVA in our iconic BV Ranches No. 1 and No. 2, originally planted by Georges de Latour in the early 1900s. We focused on clonal selections (6, 4, 169, 7, and 8), which yield small berries with the high skin-to-juice ratio needed to make intense, long-lived wines. The fruit, chosen from vines deeply rooted in well-draining alluvial fan soils, was handpicked and optically sorted to ensure the highest quality.

WINEMAKING

At our state-of-the-art winery, dedicated exclusively to crafting Georges de Latour Private Reserve Cabernet Sauvignon, a portion of the wine is fermented in new French oak barrels for early integration and a dense, rich texture. The balance of the must is fermented in stainless steel and concrete tanks to preserve the freshness of the fruit. Following judicious extended skin contact, the wine was pressed and returned to barrels for malolactic fermentation and aging. A small amount of Petit Verdot was blended with the Cabernet Sauvignon to further enhance the aroma and flavor profile. We work closely with select cooperages to ensure the style and consistency of the barrel is exactly right. This regime is very important to the elevated quality of this wine.

VARIETAL COMPOSITION:

93% Cabernet Sauvignon, 7% Petit Verdot

APPELLATION: Napa Valley

BARREL REGIME: 24 months of aging in French oak (95% new barrels)

ANALYSIS: Alcohol: 14.7%;
Total Acidity: 6.2 g/L; pH: 3.65

AGEABILITY: 2023 to 2053

HARVEST DATES:

September 14–30, 2020